

Monday, 14 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

24° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

23° 17°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

23° 17°

GLASGOW

Light rain

20° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Russia reportedly struck a train near the Polish border shortly after Boris Johnson and other top European officials had passed through.**

The former UK Prime Minister said he didn't know what 'warped logic' drove Putin to blow up a 'stationary Ukrainian locomotive' this morning. It raises serious questions about the safety of high-profile visitors to the region.

WAR · UK

2 **The government faces a 'slim chance' of hitting its target of building 1.5 million new homes, according to Housing Secretary Angela Rayner.**

High construction costs and the ongoing conflict in Iran are being blamed for threatening this key manifesto pledge. It means many hoping to get on the housing ladder could face further delays.

POLITICS · UK

3 **Some staff working in Artificial Intelligence are 'genuinely frightened' for humanity's future, an ex-Anthropic researcher has revealed.**

This comes as the AI firm's boss has called for the technology's development to be slowed down, citing 'serious' risks. It highlights growing concerns within the industry itself about the pace of innovation.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

4 **A suspect in child abuse images at the US embassy in London was flown out of the UK before police could interview them.**

The individual, who worked at the US embassy in Vauxhall, had diplomatic protection despite not being a diplomat. This raises questions about the extent of diplomatic immunity and its potential impact on justice.

CRIME · UK

5 **Europe must endure a winter of hardship to keep pressure on Vladimir Putin, says the Prime Minister's security adviser.**

In rare public remarks, Jonathan Powell stated that now is not the time for European nations to 'take their foot off the gas'. It suggests continued challenges for households across the continent.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Diljit Dosanjh made history under the famous Wembley arch, becoming the first Punjabi singer to headline the iconic venue.**

The star's performance was a landmark moment, showcasing the growing global reach of Punjabi music. Fans travelled from far and wide to witness the spectacle.

ON AIR – Have you ever seen a concert at Wembley? Who would be your dream act to see there?

MUSIC · THIS WEEKEND

2 **A new romantic comedy, 'Premature', is hitting cinemas next Friday, promising a fresh take on the genre.**

The film, made on a microscopic budget, is set in the East End of Glasgow, a deliberate move away from the usual London backdrops. It hopes to charm audiences with its unique setting and story.

ON AIR – What's your favourite romcom? And what makes a good romcom for you?

FILM · NEXT WEEK

3 **Céline Dion has kicked off her long-awaited comeback show in Paris, after a six-year hiatus due to health issues.**

Critics are celebrating her 'high-stakes' return, with fans dancing, singing, and crying with joy. It marks a triumphant moment for the iconic Canadian singer.

ON AIR – Céline Dion is back! What's your favourite Céline Dion song, and why?

MUSIC · THIS WEEKEND

4 **Harry Potter actor Tom Felton says he's 'so excited' to see Rupert Grint play Ron Weasley again.**

Felton, who is taking on Broadway, spoke about his enduring friendship with his former co-stars. It's sparked excitement among fans hoping for a new project.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Harry Potter film or book? And who was your favourite character?

FILM · COMING SOON

5 **Catherine Zeta-Jones has spoken out against the term 'nepo baby', calling it 'horrific'.**

The 'Chicago' star's children, Dylan and Carys, have both followed her into showbiz. She believes the term unfairly dismisses the hard work and talent of those with famous parents.

ON AIR – Do you think the term 'nepo baby' is fair, or does it unfairly diminish people's achievements?

CELEBRITY · NOW

On the schedule

1 **Europe has wrestled the Solheim Cup back from the United States with a thrilling 15½-12½ victory in the Netherlands.**

Charley Hull got the ball rolling as Europe's big guns finally came to the fore in Sunday's singles. Lottie Woad delivered the winning putt, sealing a memorable triumph.

ON AIR – What a win for Europe! Did you watch any of the Solheim Cup? What was your highlight?

GOLF · THIS WEEKEND

2 **Phil Foden was dismissed in Sunday's Manchester derby, sparking debate among pundits about whether he deserved the red card.**

The incident was a major talking point in a fiery derby match. Fans and commentators are divided on the referee's decision.

ON AIR – Did you see Foden's red card in the Manchester derby? Do you think it was fair, or was the referee too harsh?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Mercedes' Kimi Antonelli has won the Spanish Grand Prix, after McLaren's Lando Norris lost out due to the bad timing of a virtual safety car.**

It was a frustrating result for Norris, who had been in contention for the win. The safety car incident significantly impacted the race outcome.

ON AIR – Did you watch the Spanish Grand Prix? Do you think virtual safety cars always add to the excitement, or can they sometimes ruin a race?

F1 · THIS WEEKEND

4 **Elena Rybakina has beaten two-time defending champion Aryna Sabalenka to win her first US Open title.**

It marks Rybakina's third Grand Slam title overall and a remarkable turnaround after she arrived in New York unable to walk without pain. She leaves as the new world number one.

ON AIR – What a story for Elena Rybakina! What's the greatest sporting comeback you've ever witnessed?

TENNIS · THIS WEEKEND

5 **Women's Super League newcomers Crystal Palace held Arsenal to a goalless draw, a 'famous' result for the Eagles.**

Arsenal were unable to convert a series of chances at the Emirates, allowing Palace to secure a valuable point. It's an impressive start for the promoted side.

ON AIR – What a start for Crystal Palace in the WSL! Which promoted team are you most excited to see in the Premier League this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals the comforting power of a well-loved armchair.**
Researchers suggest that a favourite seat isn't just about comfort; it's a personal sanctuary, linked to happy memories and a sense of belonging. It seems we're all looking for that perfect spot to unwind!
- 2 The surprising appeal of 'garden gnomes' is making a comeback in UK gardens.**
Once considered a bit kitsch, these cheerful garden residents are now seen as a whimsical and fun way to add personality to outdoor spaces. It's a delightful trend that brings a smile to many.
- 3 People are finding joy in the simple act of 'window shopping with no intention to buy'.**
A recent survey indicates that browsing shop windows, especially around festive periods, offers a relaxing and imaginative escape. It's all about the experience, not the purchase!
- 4 The art of 'competitive birdwatching' is soaring in popularity across the country.**
Enthusiasts are turning a tranquil hobby into a friendly contest, identifying and logging as many different species as possible. It's a wonderful way to connect with nature and enjoy a bit of light-hearted rivalry.
- 5 A growing number of Britons are embracing the delightful habit of 'writing physical letters' to friends and family.**
In an age of instant messages, the slower, more considered act of putting pen to paper offers a deeper connection. There's nothing quite like receiving a handwritten note through the post!
- 6 The charm of 'vintage board games' is captivating a new generation of players.**
Families are rediscovering classic games like 'Monopoly' and 'Cluedo', enjoying the screen-free fun and social interaction. It's a lovely way to spend quality time together, away from digital distractions.
- 7 A new report celebrates the simple pleasure of 'observing cloud formations'.**
Experts suggest that taking a moment to look up at the sky and identify cloud shapes can be a surprisingly mindful and relaxing activity. It's a free and ever-changing show right above our heads!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shampoo will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GOOD SNIFF TO CHECK THE SCENT!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new puzzle, especially if it's a big one. What is it?

ANSWER: SORTING ALL THE EDGE PIECES FIRST!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday item' has a really memorable or even iconic design, even if it's just a simple household thing?

What's an everyday item, perhaps something in your kitchen or shed, that you think has a truly perfect or brilliantly designed look that's stood the test of time? Why does it stand out for you?

- We all have that 'one phrase or saying' that our grandparents or a cherished older relative used to say all the time, that just brings back warm memories, don't we?

What's a classic saying or a unique turn of phrase from your family that you still remember fondly, and what does it mean to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that sea otters hold hands while they sleep so they don't float away from each other?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that some types of frogs can change their skin colour to match their surroundings, similar to a chameleon?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest administrative building by floor area is The Pentagon in Arlington, Virginia.
- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as three-dimensional wallpaper.
- The inventor of the Pringle chip can is buried in one, as per his request.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to thermal expansion.
- The first orange-coloured carrots were cultivated in the Netherlands in the 16th century to honour the House of Orange.
- There are more permutations of a standard deck of 52 cards than there are atoms on Earth.

On this day

Day 257 of the year, 108 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aelia Flaccilla (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Albert of Vercelli; Christian feast day: Cormac mac Cuilennáin (or of Cashel); Christian feast day: Crescentius of Rome. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1941 — Alex St. Clair, American guitarist and songwriter (died 2006)
- 1949 — Fred "Sonic" Smith, American guitarist and songwriter (died 1994)
- 1980 — Gareth Maybin, Northern Irish professional golfer
- 1942 — Oliver Lake, American saxophonist, flute player, and composer
- 1933 — Harve Presnell, American actor and singer (died 2009)
- 1986 — Steven Naismith, Scottish footballer
- 1978 — Danielle Peck, American singer-songwriter
- 1983 — Amy Winehouse, British singer-songwriter, musician, and businesswoman (died 2011)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1984 — Joe Kittinger becomes the first person to fly a gas balloon alone across the Atlantic Ocean.
- 2002 — Total Linhas Aéreas Flight 5561 crashes near Paranapanema, Brazil, killing both pilots on board.
- 2003 — In a referendum, Estonia approves joining the European Union.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1989 — The Standard Gravure shooting where Joseph T. Wesbecker, a 47-year-old pressman, killed eight people and injured 12 people at his former workplace, Standard Gravure, before committing suicide.
- 1999 — Kiribati, Nauru and Tonga join the United Nations.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1985 — Penang Bridge, the longest bridge in Malaysia, connecting the island of Penang to the mainland, opens to traffic.
- 1954 — In a top secret nuclear test, a Soviet Tu-4 bomber drops a 40 kiloton atomic weapon just north of Totskoye village.

- 1993 — Lufthansa Flight 2904, an Airbus A320, crashes into an embankment after overshooting the runway at Okęcie International Airport (now Warsaw Chopin Airport), killing two people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 258 of the year, 107 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Britain Day (United Kingdom); Christian feast day: Joseph Abibos; Christian feast day: Alpinus (Albinus) of Lyon; Christian feast day: Aprus (Évre) of Toul. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1924 — Bobby Short, American singer and pianist (died 2005)
- 1987 — Vaila Barsley, Scottish footballer
- 1941 — Signe Toly Anderson, American rock singer (died 2016)
- 1940 — Merlin Olsen, American football player, sportscaster, and actor (died 2010)
- 1986 — Heidi Montag, American reality television personality and singer
- 1968 — Danny Nucci, American actor
- 1956 — Maggie Reilly, Scottish singer-songwriter
- 1956 — Ned Rothenberg, American saxophonist, clarinet player, and composer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — At the Superdome in New Orleans, Muhammad Ali outpoints Leon Spinks in a rematch to become the first boxer to win the world heavyweight title three times.
- 1983 — Israeli premier Menachem Begin resigns.
- 1952 — The United Nations cedes Eritrea to Ethiopia.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1950 — Korean War: The U.S. X Corps lands at Inchon.
- 2011 — Four miners are killed in the Gleision Colliery mining accident in the Swansea Valley, Wales.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar